CHALLENGE 02 · SEVEN DAYS

7 days vegan – step by step

Get to know plant foods, try new dishes and discover how varied vegan eating can be. You do not have to get everything perfect – curiosity and exploration are what matter.

Enjoy a week of plant-based food

A small focus each day – with simple tasks, ideas and inspiration.

7 days · 2 levels

Your 7-day plan

Beginner: plant-based step by step

One focus per day · No pressure to be perfect

Day	Task	Done
Day 1	**Start plant-based** Swap one familiar meal for a plant-based option, such as porridge with soy drink or bread with hummus.	☐
Day 2	**Discover legumes** Include lentils, beans, chickpeas or peas. Canned legumes are convenient – rinse and use.	☐
Day 3	**Eat colourful and seasonal** Try at least three different vegetables or fruits. Frozen vegetables count too and save time.	☐
Day 4	**Plant protein** Try tofu, tempeh, seitan or soy yoghurt. Marinating, seasoning and pan-frying until crisp can make them delicious.	☐
Day 5	**Explore dairy alternatives** Try fortified plant drinks or yoghurts. Check especially for calcium; some plant drinks are also fortified with iodine and vitamin B12.	☐
Day 6	**Veganise a favourite** Adapt a favourite dish: chilli sin carne, vegetable curry, lentil Bolognese or vegetable pizza.	☐
Day 7	**Reflect and plan** What did you enjoy? What was easy? Plan three plant-based meals for next week and note your favourites.	☐

Advanced: 7 days fully vegan

Every meal vegan · Including a nutrient check

Everything is plant-based from day 1. The daily tasks help you do it without nutrient gaps and without stress.

Day	Task	Done
Day 1	**Check your pantry and labels** Go through your fridge and pantry: where are milk, egg, butter, honey, gelatine or whey powder hiding? Read ingredient lists – animal ingredients often hide in baked goods, sauces and sweets.	☐
Day 2	**Every meal plant-based** From today, every meal is vegan. Include a protein source in each – legumes, tofu, tempeh, seitan or soy yoghurt – so you stay full for longer.	☐
Day 3	**Cover your nutrients** Start a reliable vitamin B12 supplement, use iodised salt and choose calcium-fortified plant drinks. For omega-3, linseed oil, walnuts or an algae oil work well.	☐
Day 4	**Eating out and on the go** Pack snacks – nuts, fruit or a hummus sandwich – and check the menu in advance. Many restaurants have vegan dishes or will adapt one on request.	☐
Day 5	**Cook ahead for two days** Cook a big batch of chilli, curry or lentil stew plus a grain side. It saves time and makes spur-of-the-moment exceptions less likely.	☐
Day 6	**Vegan beyond the plate** Take a look at cosmetics, toiletries and clothing – many products are labelled vegan. It is not about throwing things out right away, but about looking more closely next time you buy.	☐
Day 7	**Review and next step** How did you feel, what was missing, what was easier than expected? Decide which habits to keep and plan next week with your favourite dishes.	☐

Sample day for orientation

Breakfast: oats with soy drink, berries and linseed. Lunch: lentil Bolognese with wholewheat pasta. Snack: hummus with vegetable sticks. Dinner: tofu and vegetable stir-fry with rice.

Your training plan

Easy to prepare, satisfying and full of flavour – adjust quantities to appetite and number of servings.

Hearty · protein-rich

Chili sin carne

Ingredients

Kidney beans, black beans or corn, one can of chopped tomatoes, tomato sauce, bell pepper, onion, garlic, vegetable stock, cumin, paprika, chilli, salt and pepper. Serve with rice, cooked spelt as a wholesome rice alternative, and fresh herbs.

Method

Sauté the onion, garlic and bell pepper. First add the beans and corn and sauté for a few minutes. Only then add the canned chopped tomatoes and tomato sauce. Stir in the spices and a little vegetable stock, then simmer gently over low heat for up to 20 minutes. Season to taste and serve with rice or cooked spelt.

Pasta favourite

Tofu spaghetti Bolognese

Ingredients

Whole-wheat spaghetti, firm tofu, onion, carrot, garlic, tomato sauce, olive oil, Italian herbs, soy sauce, salt and pepper. Optional: nutritional yeast to finish.

Method

Crumble the tofu by hand and fry in olive oil until golden brown. Finely dice onion, carrot and garlic and sauté. Add tomato sauce, a splash of soy sauce and herbs; simmer for 15–20 minutes. Serve with cooked spaghetti.

Oven-baked · creamy

Baked sweet potato with filling

Ingredients

Sweet potatoes, vegan soy mince (rehydrated or prepared), chickpeas or black beans, spring onion, corn, bell pepper, lime juice, paprika, cumin, salt and pepper. For the vegan crème fraîche: unsweetened soy yoghurt or vegan crème fraîche, lemon juice, a little olive oil and salt.

Method

Pierce the sweet potatoes and bake at 200°C conventional heat for about 40–55 minutes, until tender. Prepare the vegan soy mince according to the packet instructions and briefly sauté it with beans or chickpeas, corn, bell pepper and spices. Split the sweet potatoes, add the filling and top with vegan crème fraîche mixed from soy yoghurt, lemon, oil and salt.

Crispy · customisable

Vegan pizza with tuna alternative or smoked tofu

Ingredients

Vegan pizza dough (optionally whole-wheat), tomato passata, oregano, vegan grated cheese (optional), red onion, capers and olives. Choose either plant-based vegan tuna or smoked tofu as topping, with a little lemon juice and fresh herbs.

Method

Roll out the dough and spread with seasoned tomato sauce. Top with onion, capers, olives and vegan tuna or diced smoked tofu. Bake according to the dough instructions – usually at 220–250°C – until the crust is crisp. Finish with lemon juice and herbs.

Stew · wholesome

Lentil and tomato stew with spelt

Ingredients

Red lentils or a mixed lentil blend, one can of chopped tomatoes, sweet potato, smoked tofu, carrot, courgette, broccoli, onion, garlic, vegetable stock, paprika, thyme, salt and pepper. Serve with spelt (spelt berries or spelt rice).

Method

Cook the spelt separately in its own pot according to the packet instructions. In the stew pot, sauté the onion, garlic and diced smoked tofu. Add the carrot and sweet potato and cook briefly. Then add the courgette and sauté it before adding the canned chopped tomatoes and vegetable stock. You can add the red lentils or mixed lentil blend directly to the stew and cook according to the packet instructions, or cook them separately in another pot and stir them in later. Red lentils usually take about 10–15 minutes, while a mixed blend may need longer. Sauté the broccoli separately and stir it into the stew at the end. Alternatively, add it with the other vegetables from the beginning and let it cook in the stew. Season to taste and serve with the separately cooked spelt.

Photo credits: Flavur · Food.com · Lotao · Garden Gourmet · Radio NWW.

01

Keep shopping simple

Oats, potatoes, whole grains, legumes, tofu, nuts, vegetables and fruit make a versatile foundation.

02

Build balanced meals

Combine vegetables or fruit with a protein source, satisfying carbohydrates and a fat source – for example lentils, rice, vegetables and tahini.

03

Remember B12

A reliable vitamin B12 source is essential in a vegan diet, usually through an appropriate supplement. A one-week challenge does not replace long-term planning.

Good to know

A balanced vegan diet requires some planning. A well-formulated vegan all-in-one supplement may help reduce potential nutrient gaps, depending on its ingredients and dosage, especially when food choices are not balanced or you are unsure about your intake. Pay particular attention to a reliable source of vitamin B12. In addition, an EPA/DHA algae oil, for example from Sunday Natural, can support the intake of long-chain omega-3 fatty acids. Supplements do not replace a balanced diet and do not automatically meet every individual need. Check the formulation and dosage; a qualified nutrition professional can help if you are unsure.

My notes